

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 1563

By Carringer

A RESOLUTION to honor and commend M. Kevin Knowles upon his retirement as Director of East Tennessee State Veterans Cemeteries.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should specially recognize those citizens who have performed with uncommon devotion and enthusiasm throughout their years of public service; and

WHEREAS, M. Kevin Knowles is one such estimable person, who is taking a well-earned retirement as Director of the East Tennessee State Veterans Cemeteries after years of dedicated service to the State of Tennessee and its veterans; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Knowles has more than four decades of experience in cemetery and funeral service, demonstrating exceptional leadership, professionalism, and a steadfast commitment to the families and communities he has served; and

WHEREAS, since 2016, he has served as Director of East Tennessee State Veterans Cemeteries in Knoxville, overseeing the daily operations of multiple facilities, supervising staff, and ensuring the dignified interment of those who have honorably served in the United States Armed Forces; and

WHEREAS, in this role, Kevin Knowles has directed the administration of more than one thousand pre-registration applications and hundreds of interments annually, working in conjunction with the United States Department of Veterans Affairs National Cemetery Administration to ensure compliance with national standards; and

WHEREAS, under his leadership, the East Tennessee State Veterans Cemeteries received the National Cemetery Administration's Operational Excellence Award in 2023, a prestigious honor awarded to only a select few cemeteries nationwide in recognition of outstanding performance; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Knowles has held numerous leadership positions in the funeral and cemetery profession, including roles with Service Corporation International and Stewart Enterprises, as well as service as a senior licensed funeral director and embalmer; and

WHEREAS, Kevin Knowles has also demonstrated a commitment to professional development and public service through his licensure and certifications, including his work as a certified disaster casualty responder and his participation in leadership programs such as the Tennessee Government Management Institute and LEAD Tennessee; and

WHEREAS, in addition to his professional accomplishments, he has been an active member of his community, serving as a volunteer with the Knoxville Area Rescue Ministry and as a deacon at New Providence Presbyterian Church; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Knowles is most grateful for the love and support he shares with his wife, Lauryi, their three children and three granddaughters; and

WHEREAS, a public-spirited citizen of the highest order, Kevin Knowles has compiled a singular record of success during his exemplary career; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Knowles is wholly committed to the noble precepts of public service that have earned Tennessee recognition as the Volunteer State, and he should be specially recognized; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor and commend M. Kevin Knowles for his honorable and astute service to the people of Tennessee, particularly the veterans of this State, and extend to him our best wishes for a happy and fulfilling retirement.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.